



Nvidia RTX 3080 Ti

Specifications of the Nvidia RTX 3080 Ti show that it is 78% more powerful than the Nvidia RTX 2080 Ti. <https://digit.in/jul20-95>



Oculus gone

Facebook has stopped sales and decided to discontinue its entry level VR headset, Oculus Go. <https://digit.in/jul20-96>

Xiaomi Mi 10

A wholesome flagship

The Xiaomi Mi 10 is the company's third attempt to break into the premium segment, after being absent from it for a few years. The Mi 10 launched amidst the worst pandemic the world has seen in recent years, making it even more difficult for the company to convince buyers to pitch in half a lakh for a Qualcomm Snapdragon 865 processor, especially when the brand is known for its low-cost smartphones. The task gets even more difficult when there's already a Snapdragon 865-powered flagship available for ₹34,990.

Build

The Mi 10's design can hardly be called original, but it does carry the flair of a flagship. With a glass sandwich design and slim edges, it's nice to hold. Single-handed use is very much possible but we had to adjust our grip every time we wanted to lock the screen by pressing the power button after typing out a text. The phone also lacks an official IP rating, but it does have the same P2i coating like in the Redmi Note 9 Pro.

Speaking of the display, this is hands down the best display Xiaomi has ever made, at least among the one that had the good fortune of launching in India. The panel is HDR10+ certified and stretches 6.67-inches with curved edges like the OnePlus 7T Pro. The panel is punctuated by a punch-hole selfie camera that's tucked in the top left corner, and we don't find it marring the experience of watching a movie or playing a game on the phone.

Performance

The Qualcomm Snapdragon 865 inside the phone basically guarantees top-notch performance in Android flagships. Qualcomm has made some incremental changes in the architecture that does show a boost in performance in the benchmark numbers, but to be frank, we didn't feel any difference

coming from the ROG Phone II. Xiaomi is also using the full suite of Snapdragon 865, that includes all the RF upgrades required for 5G connectivity, and Snapdragon Elite Gaming features.

In terms of daily usage, the Mi 10 feels smooth and fast. It takes less than 30 seconds to boot up, and when unlocked, goes instantly to the homescreen. The ultrasonic fingerprint sensor is fast, but you will hardly get to use it when face recognition is turned on. The phone's 90Hz display also makes things appear smoother when scrolling down a menu or simply swiping across the home screen. In all, the Mi 10 is just as good as any other flagship from 2020.

Now let's look at gaming, what has become a cornerstone in our performance testing. We did short sessions of PUBG Mobile, CoD: Mobile and the new Forza Street and measured performance using GameBench. The results, not surprisingly, are quite impressive. Both CoD: Mobile and PUBG Mobile hit 60 FPS with 100% stability-indicating there were no frame drops in the sessions. But before you go out and brag, remember the iQOO 3 5G and the Realme X50 Pro 5G also performs sim-

ilarly with everything maxed out. The phone also didn't heat up even though we played with all settings maxed out in a non-air-conditioned room with the Delhi summer at full blaze.

Cameras

The Mi 10 is the first smartphone under ₹50,000 to rock the 108MP camera sensor developed by Samsung. The sensor measures 1/1.33", second only to the size of the custom sensor used in the Huawei P40 Pro+. The large sensor size accommodates more than a 100 million 0.8 micron pixels, which helps in achieving noise-free digital zoom and a fair amount of detail at 100% crop. The sensor also outputs 27MP photos by default by binning four neighbouring 0.8um pixels into a large 1.6um pixels, the same technology used in the previous 48MP and 64MP cameras.

Aside from the 108MP camera, there camera setup is disappointingly average. There's a 13MP ultrawide and two 2MP sensors for macro and portrait photos. Indeed, the final

JPEG output is largely improved by the new Spectra ISP on the Snapdragon 865 which works in tandem with Xiaomi's colour-boosting AI algorithm and HDR mode to produce photos that look highly palatable.

Bottom line

The price tag is on the higher side if you compare with the 5G flagships launched this year, but for the premium, the Mi 10 offers an excellent display and a reliable primary camera alongside flagship performance chops.

—Subhrojit Mallick

SPECIFICATIONS

OS: MIUI 11 | CHIP: Qualcomm Snapdragon 865 SoC + X55 Modem | GPU: Adreno 650 GPU | MEMORY: 8+128GB / 8+256GB | BATTERY: 4780 mAh | CAMERAS: 108MP Quad Camera, 13MP ultra wide angle | FRONT CAMERA: 20MP | DISPLAY: 6.67" 3D Curved E3 AMOLED Display

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Price
₹49,999



FEATURES.....	77
PERFORMANCE.....	77
BUILD.....	75
VALUE.....	60